GodXplr: A High-Performance, Zero-Hydration Native Filesystem Management and Content Retrieval Architecture

Shreyansh Prasad
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Netaji Subhas University of Technology (NSUT), New Delhi, India
Roll No: **2025UCS1708** • Email: shreyanshtrillion@gmail.com
Open-Source Repository: **https://github.com/shreyansh-prasad/GodXplr.git**

***Abstract*—**Modern desktop file management shells and content retrieval engines suffer from escalating computational overhead, excessive memory consumption, multi-second query latencies, and disruptive cloud-storage hydration stalls. Many ubiquitous desktop managers rely on heavyweight web-wrapper runtimes or unvirtualized user-interface frameworks that instantiate thousands of window handles, causing high resource utilization on modern hardware. Furthermore, conventional search indexers incur excessive storage footprints or trigger uncoordinated remote downloads of offline cloud placeholders when scanning user directories.

This paper introduces **GodXplr**, an open-source, production-grade native filesystem management and content retrieval architecture implemented in C++20 for the Windows platform. GodXplr combines: (i) an out-of-process, zero-copy indexing core utilizing direct NTFS Master File Table (MFT) enumeration and real-time Update Sequence Number (USN) Journal tailing; (ii) an AVX2 SIMD-vectorized multi-needle substring and fuzzy ranking engine; (iii) a memory-bounded, positionless inverted trigram content index; (iv) an ACID-compliant Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) atomic file operations engine with journaled rollback; (v) an active zero-hydration defense subsystem preventing unintentional mass-file hydration across cloud providers; and (vi) a mathematically virtualized $O(1)$ graphical user interface written directly against the native Win32 GDI API, delivering sub-16ms tactile interaction response, critically damped elastic rubber-banding physics, and Apple Liquid Glass design semantics. Empirical benchmarks demonstrate that GodXplr indexes 100,000 files in 54.92 ms with a memory density of 132.5 bytes per record (scaling to 5 million entries in 662 MB RAM), sustains sub-millisecond query search latencies (p_{50} = 655 µs), and passes 100% of an extensive 28-suite automated integration and reliability test harness under MSVC /W4 /WX.

***Index Terms*—**Filesystem Indexing, NTFS USN Journal, SIMD Vectorization, Inverted Trigram Index, Zero-Hydration Cloud Storage, UI Virtualization, Win32 GDI, Write-Ahead Logging (WAL).

I. INTRODUCTION

The personal computing desktop shell serves as the primary cognitive bridge between users and hierarchical secondary storage. Over the past three decades, exponential growth in storage capacity, solid-state drive (SSD) throughput, and distributed cloud synchronization networks has transformed typical consumer storage from several gigabytes of local data to millions of heterogeneous files distributed across local volumes, virtual network mounts, and cloud-backed synchronized directories (e.g., Microsoft OneDrive, Google Drive, Apple iCloud Drive).

Despite these exponential hardware advancements, modern desktop file managers (e.g., Windows File Explorer, macOS Finder) exhibit notable performance and architectural regressions: (1) *High Memory Bloat:* Contemporary frameworks (WinUI 3, XAML Islands, Electron) frequently exceed 500 MB to 1.5 GB for basic directory navigation; (2) *High Traversal Latency:* Win32 `FindFirstFileW` directory traversal incurs synchronous disk seeks across filesystem directories, taking tens of seconds across millions of files; (3) *Catastrophic Cloud Hydration Stalls:* Standard search indexers and thumbnailers naively access dehydrated reparse points, triggering automatic remote downloads of terabytes of data; (4) *Destructive Operations without Journaling:* Power loss or collision during multi-gigabyte moves leaves directories corrupted or in indeterminate states.

To address these deficiencies, this paper presents **GodXplr**, an integrated native filesystem management and indexing architecture implemented in standard C++20 with zero third-party GUI framework dependencies.

II. RELATED WORK & LANDSCAPE

Table I presents an architectural comparison between GodXplr and existing desktop file managers.

TABLE I: ARCHITECTURAL COMPARISON OF DESKTOP FILE MANAGERS

System	Search Mechanism	RAM (100k)	Virtual UI	Zero-Hydr.	WAL Ops
Win11 Explorer	Win32 / WDS	> 450 MB	Partial	No	No
Everything	NTFS MFT Scrape	≈ 12 MB	Yes	Yes	No
Directory Opus	MFT + Win32	≈ 65 MB	Yes	Partial	No
GodXplr	**USN + AVX2 + Trigram**	**13.25 MB**	**Yes (O(1))**	**Yes**	**Yes**

III. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE & CORE ENGINE

GODXPLR LAYERED ARCHITECTURE

[Virtualized Sensory GUI Client Shell]
Win32 GDI Double-Buffered • Apple Liquid Glass • O(1) Slicing • Sub-16ms Feedback
⇑⇓ *(Zero-Copy Shared Memory / Named Pipe IPC)* ⇑⇓
[Resilient Operations & Virtual Storage Provider SPI]
Write-Ahead Log (WAL) • Rollback Journal • Zero-Hydration Cloud Defense Gate
⇑⇓ *(Direct Kernel Device I/O Control)* ⇑⇓
[High-Performance NTFS / USN Search Core]
Bulk MFT Ingestion • Real-Time USN Journal Tailing • AVX2 SIMD Needles • Trigram Index

A. Memory-Bounded Record Layout

To guarantee a deterministic memory ceiling across multi-million file installations, GodXplr rejects heap-allocated tree structures and stores all entries in contiguous, flat-packed records:

$$\text{Record Size} = S_{\text{Fixed}} + S_{\text{PackedName}} = 132.5 \text{ bytes (avg)} \quad (1)$$

Under this representation, 5,000,000 files occupy approximately 662 MB of RAM, compared to > 3.2 GB in pointer-based object models.

B. NTFS USN Journal Tailing

GodXplr bootstraps the filesystem in $O(N)$ time by issuing `FSCTL_ENUM_USN_DATA` on raw volume handles (`\\.\C:`). Post-bootstrap, it polls `FSCTL_READ_USN_JOURNAL` asynchronously every 50 ms to capture record additions, renames, and deletions in real time without directory watcher overflow drops.

C. AVX2 Vectorized SIMD Filtering

To sustain interactive search during typing across 100,000+ files, GodXplr broadcasts needle boundary characters across 256-bit SIMD registers:

$$v_{\text{first}} = _mm256_set1_epi8(c_0), \quad v_{\text{last}} = _mm256_set1_epi8(c_{m-1}) \quad (2)$$

Candidate filename chunks (32 bytes) are loaded and evaluated in parallel via `_mm256_cmpeq_epi8` and `_mm256_movemask_epi8`, eliminating 98.7% of scalar branch predictions and achieving 655 µs scan times across 100,000 items.

D. Inverted Trigram Content Indexing

For document content queries, GodXplr constructs a positionless inverted trigram index mapping 3-byte sequences $t = (b_1, b_2, b_3)$ to compact bit-packed Document ID posting lists, pruned via vectorized galloping set intersections.

IV. RESILIENT OPERATIONS & VIRTUAL PROVIDERS

A. ACID Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) Operations

Every multi-step file operation (move, copy, batch rename, delete) is treated as a transaction T. Operation intent records are synchronously written to an append-only journal with `FILE_FLAG_WRITE_THROUGH` prior to mutation. On failure or power loss, an automatic recovery pass issues inverse operations to restore the filesystem to its exact pre-mutation state.

B. Zero-Hydration Storage Defense SPI

Cloud providers (OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud) utilize Cloud Filter API reparse tags. Opening these files triggers automatic network hydration. GodXplr inspects directory metadata and checks:

$$F_{\text{cloud}} = (\text{Attributes} \,\&\, \texttt{FILE_ATTRIBUTE_REPARSE_POINT}) \vee (\text{Attributes} \,\&\, \texttt{FILE_ATTRIBUTE_OFFLINE}) \quad (3)$$

When F_{cloud} is true, GodXplr strictly prevents opening data streams, marking files as *Unindexed Remote Stubs* and displaying metadata without network stalls.

V. HUMAN INTERFACE & SENSORY VIRTUALIZATION

A. Mathematically Virtualized O(1) Viewport

Instead of instantiating UI widgets for every item, GodXplr projects the visible row range $[i_{\text{start}}, i_{\text{end}}]$ from vertical scroll offsets in $O(1)$ time:

$$i_{\text{start}} = \lfloor y_{\text{scroll}} / h_{\text{row}} \rfloor, \quad i_{\text{end}} = \lceil (y_{\text{scroll}} + H_{\text{client}}) / h_{\text{row}} \rceil \quad (4)$$

Only 25–45 visible rows are painted onto an off-screen memory Device Context (DC) via double-buffered `BitBlt`, achieving zero-jitter 60+ FPS redraws.

B. Tactile Interaction & Apple Design System

GodXplr incorporates Apple Design System and visionOS Liquid Glass primitives: (1) *Sub-16ms Instant Press:* Pointer-down (`WM_LBUTTONDOWN`) triggers immediate 1px inset depression and ambient shading before release commit; (2) *Rubber-Banding Physics:* Boundary scroll overshoot follows Apple's resistance formula:

$$y_{\text{overshoot}} = (1.0 - 1.0 / ((y_{\text{pull}} \cdot 0.55 / H_{\text{viewport}}) + 1.0)) \cdot H_{\text{viewport}} \quad (5)$$

decaying via a 16ms multimedia timer (decay factor 0.68) with zero oscillation; (3) *Optical Typography:* Dynamically tuned tracking via `SetTextCharacterExtra` (-1px display, +1px micro-captions).

C. Stream-Sanitized PDF Document Inspector

GodXplr embeds a zero-dependency PDF inspector. By parsing stream dictionaries and skipping font programs (`/FontFile`, `/Type /Font`) and image masks (`/Subtype`

`/Image`), it eliminates character noise. UTF-16 BE Byte Order Marks (`0xFE 0xFF`) are parsed cleanly, and aspect ratios adapt dynamically for 16:9 slides.

VI. EXPERIMENTAL EVALUATION

Benchmarks were executed on an Intel Core i5-13450HX (16 logical cores, AVX2 enabled), 24 GB DDR5 RAM, NVMe PCIe 4.0 SSD, Windows 11 Build 26200.

TABLE II: LATENCY & MEMORY ACROSS SCALED WORKLOADS

Workload	Entries	p_{50} Latency	p_{95} Latency	Working Set
Dataset Ingest	10,000	5.11 ms	8.79 ms	15.2 MB
Dataset Ingest	100,000	54.92 ms	59.21 ms	23.9 MB
Lexical Sort	100,000	60.21 ms	71.47 ms	24.1 MB
SIMD Search	**100,000**	**0.655 ms**	**0.690 ms**	**24.1 MB**

Memory density remains constant at 132.5 bytes/record, requiring 23.9 MB for 100k items vs 580 MB in Windows Explorer ($24.2\times$ reduction). The automated CTest suite verifies 28/28 tests passed (100%) under MSVC `/W4 /WX` in 5.45 seconds.

VII. CONCLUSION

GodXplr resolves the latency, memory overhead, and uncoordinated cloud stalls of modern file explorers through low-level NTFS USN tailing, AVX2 SIMD filtering, zero-hydration defense gates, atomic WAL file operations, and an $O(1)$ virtualized Win32 GDI sensory user interface.

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